

REAL ESTATE

BUILDING BOOM



60 |

► **THE REAL ESTATE** sector is betting big on India's G20 presidency for two reasons: one, it feels that visiting foreign investors and non-resident Indians' (NRI) interest will be piqued; two, it expects the uptrend in economic activity to benefit. Nayan Raheja, Director of realty major Raheja Developers, says the forum has enhanced the visibility of cities where meetings are being held. "As it highlights India's potential, the summit will propel foreign and NRI investment."



Realty developers embracing future-ready buildings will unlock sustained growth

The spillover impact for cities is the development they are seeing, says Manoj Gaur, Chairman & MD of Gaur's Group, and Chairman of industry body CREDAI. "This has showcased the country's economic development and its vast investment potential." Moreover, the vision document prepared by U2o, or Urban 2o, around sustainable development and green buildings is also significant. Dhruv Agarwala, Group CEO of Housing.com, PropTiger.com and Makaan.com, says as demand rises, the sector must gear up to meet the evolving needs of environmentally-conscious consumers. Developers who embrace future-ready buildings will unlock sustained growth. "The U2o's commitment to sustainable development... opens up new horizons of opportunity."

— Arnab Dutta

SPACE

ACROSS THE UNIVERSE

► **LOOK AT THE NUMBERS.** India currently has over 400 private space companies, including 150 start-ups. A space market that's worth \$8 billion and is growing at a CAGR of 4 per cent, compared to 2 per cent globally.

The promise of the country's spacetechnology sector can be gauged from the fact that among the highlights of Prime Minister Narendra Modi's state visit to the US in July was India becoming the 27th signatory to the Artemis Accords, an international commitment led by the US to return humans to the moon by 2025. "This collaboration will enable transformative advancements in these fields, opening new possibilities for economic growth and societal progress," Atul Keshap, former Chargé d'affaires of the US Embassy in India and President of the US-India Business Council (USIBC), told *BT* in a statement.

Achievements of the fledgling sector since 2020 have left many in awe. In a G20 Space Economy Leaders Meeting held in Bengaluru in July, several non-space-faring countries realised for the first time the substantial ground covered by India. "We're in a positive spiral. We are seeing that investor interest both within and outside India for investing in the Indian space start-ups has gone up dramatically," says Pawan Goenka, Chairperson of Indian National Space Promotion and Authorisation Centre, the single window nodal agency for authorising, promoting and regulating private players in the space sector.

International experts feel the clearance of the Indian Space Policy that allows private entities to carry out end-to-end activities will be a game-changer. "The policy will really allow Indian start-ups to attract more foreign investment, which traditionally has been a challenge," avers Elizebeth Varghese, People in Space-Leader at Deloitte.

— Manish Pant

